

The `caption` package*

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Abstract

The `caption` package provides many ways to customise the captions in floating environments such `figure` and `table`. The `\rotcaption` command and the `sidewaysfigure` and `sidewaystable` environments provided by the `rotating` package from S. Rahtz and L. Barroca are also supported. The `caption` package also cooperates with the `float` package written by A. Lingnau and the `subfigure` package written by S.D. Cochran.

1 The user interface

To use this package just type

```
\usepackage[<options>]{caption}
```

in the preamble of your document, where the following options are supported:

<code>normal</code>	provides ‘normal’ captions, this is the default
<code>hang</code> or <code>isu</code>	provides captions with hanging indention
<code>center</code>	provides captions where each line is centered
<code>centerlast</code>	provides captions where the last line of the paragraph is centered
<code>nooneline</code>	if a caption fits on <i>one</i> line on the page, it will be centered. If you don’t like this behaviour, just select this option.
<code>scriptsize</code> , ..., <code>Large</code>	sets the font size of the captions
<code>up</code> , <code>it</code> , <code>sl</code> , <code>sc</code> , <code>md</code> , <code>bf</code> , <code>rm</code> , <code>sf</code> , or <code>tt</code>	sets the font attribute of the caption labels.
<code>ruled</code>	supports ruled floats of the <code>float</code> package, see section 1.1 for details

<code>\captionfont</code> <code>\captionlabelfont</code>	To setup the font size and attributes of the captions, this package also provides
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*This package has version number 1.4b, last revised 1995/04/05.

the commands `\captionfont` and `\captionlabelfont` to allow a more flexible way to customize the captions than the above options could do. `\captionfont` is called before each caption, `\captionlabelfont` is called just before the label of the caption, so the whole caption will be created as

```
\captionfont{\captionlabelfont <label>: }<caption>}
```

Note that these commands are used by the options, e.g. the options `small` and `sf` are identical to

```
\renewcommand{\captionfont}{\small} and
\renewcommand{\captionlabelfont}{\sffamily}
```

`\captionmargin` Furthermore there is a new length `\captionmargin` to setup an extra left and right margin for the captions, e.g. the command

```
\setlength{\captionmargin}{10pt}
```

sets this margin to 10pt.

`\abovecaptionskip` The lengths `\abovecaptionskip` and `\belowcaptionskip` contain the amount of
`\belowcaptionskip` white space to leave above and below the caption. `\abovecaptionskip` is preset (in the `article`, `report` and `book` document class) to 10pt, `\belowcaptionskip` to 0pt.

1.1 The rotating, float and subfigure package

If you want to use this package together with the `rotating`[1], `float`[2] and/or the subfigure package, you have to input this package *after* the other ones, like

```
\usepackage{float,rotating,subfigure}
\usepackage[centerlast,small,sc]{caption}
```

The `caption` package now redefines the `sidewaysfigure` and `sidewaystable` environments and the `\rotcaption` command provided by the `rotating` package from S. Rahtz and L. Barroca. Note that the `\captionmargin` does not affect the `\rotcaption` command.

It also redefines the captions of the `plain` and `boxed` styled floats provided by the `float` package from A. Lingnau. `ruled` floats are not supported by default, but you can change this via setting the option `ruled`. Note that the `\captionmargin` is not supported in ruled floats.

If the `subfigure` package from S.D. Cochran is detected, the options `scriptsize`, ..., `large` will redefine `\subcapsize` in an adequate way. If you redefine `\captionfont` by yourself and use the `subfigure` package, you also have to redefine `\subcapsize` by yourself. Also the commands `\@thesubfigure` and `\@thesubtable` will be redefined to use the `\captionlabelfont` command, please take this into consideration if you redefine `\@thesubfigure` or `\@thesubtable` by yourself. E.g. a adequate version of the second example in `subfigure.sty` will be:

```
\renewcommand{\thesubfigure}{\thefigure.\arabic{subfigure}}
```

```

\makeatletter
\renewcommand{\@thesubfigure}{\captionlabelfont\thesubfigure:}\space}
\renewcommand{\p@subfigure}{}
\makeatother
...

```

This package cooperates with the version 2.8 (1995/04/02) of the `rotating` package, version 1.2c (1995/03/29) of the `float` package and version 1.6 (1993/05/13) of the `subfigure` package, but will hopefully work with future versions, too.

2 Example

Here's an example figure which was produced with the following code in the preamble of this document:

```

\usepackage[hang,small,bf]{caption}
\setlength{\captionmargin}{20pt}

```

EXAMPLE FIGURE

Figure 1: This is an example caption with a small font and a sans serif label. The hang option was used. There is a left and right margin of 20pt.

References

- [1] Sebastian Rahtz and Leonor Barroca: *A style option for rotated objects in L^AT_EX*, 1994/10/02
- [2] Anselm Lingnau: *An Improved Environment for Floats*, 1995/03/25
- [3] Michel Goossens, Frank Mittelbach and Alexander Samarin: *The L^AT_EX Companion*, Addison-Wesley, Reading, Massachusetts, 1994.
- [4] Anne Brüggemann-Klein: *Einführung in die Dokumentverarbeitung*, B.G. Teubner, Stuttgart, 1989
- [5] Helmut Kopka: *L^AT_EX- Erweiterungsmöglichkeiten*, 3. überarbeitete Auflage, Addison-Wesley, Bonn, 1991